AREESH AZIZ

SECURITY ENGINEERING | CLOUD SECURITY | DETECTION AND RESPONSE

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EDUCATION

B.S. in Cybersecurity | University of South Florida, Bellini College · Tampa, Florida **Expected May 2027**

Honors: Dean's List; Boyadjian in Armenian Studies Scholarship; WiCyS Security Training Scholarship, Tier 1 (with SANS Institute)

Relevant Coursework: Network Security and Firewalls; Penetration Testing; Cloud Computing for IT (AWS); Advanced Database Systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Student IT Assistant | Lab for Research and Innovation in Cybersecurity, USF **Aug 2026 - Present**

- Secure and administer access to GAIVI, a shared Linux GPU/HPC research cluster: provisioning access through Active Directory, SSSD/PAM, Slurm, NFS/ZFS storage quotas, and Ansible, with changes tracked in Jira.
- Engineered a read-only identity-lifecycle audit of 306 accounts, correlating SSH history, storage metadata, and 894,476 Slurm records with Bash and Python; flagged 170 accounts without qualifying activity and 92 orphaned home directories (about 1,272 GiB) for review, not deletion.
- Troubleshot Cisco 2800-series lab routers over serial console and ROMMON (isolating bent CompactFlash pins), a missing NFS share on a GPU node, and Linux workstation network failures.

Microsoft Student Ambassador | University of South Florida **Aug 2026 - Present**

- Selected through a competitive interview process; partner with a fellow ambassador and a faculty advisor to modernize Microsoft 365 support for USF Faculty Senate councils (CTIR and UGC).
- Built and tested a scheduled Power Automate flow that synced all 20 council seats into the CTIR dashboard daily, and reported roster mismatches to council leadership, including 4 seated members still listed as pending.
- Redesigning it with Copilot and Agent Builder; coordinate the UGC AI Review Assistant subcommittee.

Systems Engineer Intern | VSP Vision · Sacramento, CA / Remote **Feb 2025 - Dec 2025**

- Automated Windows 11 migration and compliance validation across 800+ enterprise endpoints with Python and PowerShell, reducing deployment time by 30%.
- Designed an SCCM–ServiceNow CVE remediation workflow that accelerated ticket triage by 40%; analyzed Defender telemetry to improve remediation prioritization by 35%, and resolved 50+ endpoint issues.

Software Security Intern | MileTap · Karachi, Pakistan **May 2024 - Aug 2024**

- Tested five applications with Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Snyk, and Checkmarx, finding 30+ vulnerabilities; authored OWASP Top 10-aligned Secure Development Guidelines adopted by engineering.

ADDITIONAL SECURITY EXPERIENCE

Tier 1 Participant | WiCyS Security Training Scholarship with SANS Institute **Oct 2026 - Present**

- Competed in the SANS BootUp CTF: cryptography, SQL injection, JWT forgery, IDOR, cloud IAM escalation, and forensics and moved to Tier 2.

Security Researcher | WiCyS Vulnerability Disclosure Program · Bugcrowd **Apr 2026 - May 2026**

- Perform authorized OWASP Top 10 web security testing under responsible disclosure rules and document reproducible findings.

IT Shadowing Participant | WiCyS x USF IT **Mar 2026 - Apr 2026**

- Shadowed Security Operations, Network Engineering, and Microsoft 365 teams on incident handling and Agile security triage.

SELECTED PERSONAL SECURITY PROJECTS

Detection Engineering Lab | Splunk, Python, Windows and Linux Telemetry **Jan 2026 - March 2026**

- Ingested 10,000+ events into Splunk and wrote detections for brute-force logins and suspicious PowerShell; investigated 40,000+ events in ReliaQuest GreyMatter labs.

Network Security Lab | VMware, OPNsense, Windows Server, Kali, DVWA **Aug 2026 - Present**

- Built a segmented lab behind an OPNsense firewall and documented brute-force, command injection, CSRF, and SQL injection attacks and their mitigations.

Application Security and Whitelisting Governance | Python, Defender, SCCM, ServiceNow **Nov 2025 - Jan 2026**

- Designed a software-inventory and risk-classification workflow linking Defender and SCCM metadata with ServiceNow CMDB to flag unapproved executables, track exceptions, and support audits.

SKILLS AND CERTIFICATIONS

Technical: Python, PowerShell, Bash, SQL; Linux, Active Directory, Azure/Entra ID, AWS, Microsoft 365, Power Automate, Ansible, Docker, VMware; Splunk, Defender, SCCM, ServiceNow, Wireshark, Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Hashcat; NIST CSF, MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP Top 10

Certifications: Google Cybersecurity Certificate; Splunk SIEM Training; Timus Certified Specialist; ISC2 CC and CompTIA Security+ (in progress)

Awards: 4th Place, USF Hack The Bay CTF; Best Use of Snowflake APIs, Hackabull 2026; Best Project Manager of the Year 2022, Nixor Productions